

STRAWBERRY DREAM MITTENS

PREEMIE TO 2 MONTHS

Soft thumbless mittens with a folded rib cuff, leaf tips, seeds and a connecting i-cord between the two.
Graded in two sizes covering the whole Strawberry Dream collection.

Small

size 32-44

Large

size 50-56

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Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. **Test knit version 1.0**

BEFORE YOU START

The mittens are worked in the round from the cuff towards the fingertips. The green rib folds outwards in wear. The leaf panel gives way to pink stocking stitch with a few seeds, and the mitten is finished with even decreases. The mittens have no thumb, which is usual for baby mittens: a thumb creates a seam and an edge where a small hand can catch.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- knitting small rounds with Magic Loop or double-pointed needles
- working colourwork with short floats
- shaping a rounded mitten top
- knitting and attaching an i-cord between the mittens

DIFFICULTY

Easy to slightly experienced. The mittens are the smallest piece in the collection, and a good place to try out both the gauge and the leaf chart before starting a larger garment.

SIZES AND FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

The mittens are graded in two sizes, not five like the garments. One leaf repeat is 8 stitches, approx. 3.8 cm round, and a baby hand grows less than that from premature to two months. Two sizes are therefore two real measurements, not two names for the same thing. Measure the baby hand round the knuckles, or choose by the garment size.

Small

size 32-44

Large

size 50-56

WHICH SIZE TO CHOOSE

Size	Fits garment size	Hand circumference
Small	32-44	11,4 cm
Large	50-56	15,2 cm

FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

Size	Stitches round	Leaf repeats	Cuff before folding	Length without cuff	Cord
Small	24 sts	3 x	5 cm	10,6 cm	40 cm
Large	32 sts	4 x	6 cm	12,1 cm	50 cm

The mittens should sit loosely. They must come off with one hand, and are held in place by the folded cuff, not by being tight.

YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. 4 mm needles, double-pointed or Magic Loop for the small rounds. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

Tools	For what
4 mm needles	double-pointed or Magic Loop, the rounds are very small
Darning needle	for weaving in ends and sewing on the i-cord
Stitch marker	to mark the beginning of the round

YARN AMOUNT

Size	Pink	Green	Cream
Small	10 g	15 g	5 g
Large	15 g	20 g	5 g

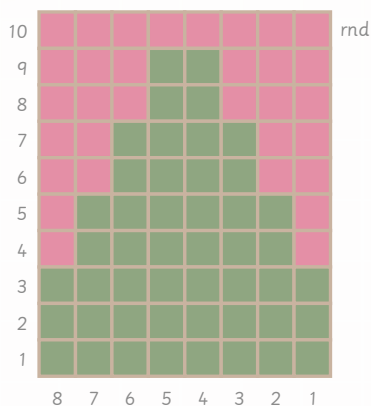
GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means going up a needle size, fewer means going down. The gauge decides every measurement in the pattern, and on garments this small a slight difference quickly becomes several centimetres.

LEAF AND SEED CHARTS

Both charts are read from the bottom up, and each round from right to left, the same way you knit. The leaf repeat is 8 stitches and is repeated all the way round the yoke. The number of repeats for your size is given further on.

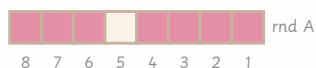
LEAF, 8 STITCHES x 10 ROUNDS



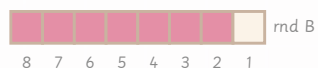
● leaf green ● strawberry pink ● cream white, one seed

SEED, 8 STITCHES

A



B



The seeds are single cream white stitches scattered over the pink. Work round A, then 2-3 rounds in pink, then round B. Repeat as densely or as sparsely as you like.

The float behind the work is never longer than 3 stitches in either chart. That is deliberate: long loose strands on the inside are both uncomfortable against the skin and something small fingers can catch in. Keep the carried yarn loose enough that the work does not pucker.

1 • CUFF AND LEAF TIPS

Cast on in green, join in the round and work *k2, p2* until the rib measures the height in your column. The rib folds outwards in wear, which is why it is this deep. Work 1 round in knit.

Size	Cast on	Rib	Leaf repeats round
Small	24 sts	5 cm	3 x
Large	32 sts	6 cm	4 x

THE LEAF TIPS

Work the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches and repeat it round as many times as your column says. Change to pink after the last chart round and work 1 round in knit.

2 • THE HAND AND THE SEEDS

Work in pink stocking stitch in the round. On a seed round work seed round A from page 5, that is *3 pink, 1 cream, 4 pink*, repeated round. Work 3 rounds in pink. Then work seed round B, that is *7 pink, 1 cream*, repeated round. Continue in pink until the hand measures the length in your column, measured from the leaf tips.

Size	Stitches	Hand in pink
Small	24 sts	4,5 cm
Large	32 sts	6,0 cm

Two seed rounds are enough on such a small area. More becomes busy, and every extra cream stitch is another end to weave in on the inside.

3 • SHAPING THE TOP

Decrease as in the table, with 1 knit round between each decrease round. Read your row from left to right: each column is the stitch count you should have after that decrease round. Cut the yarn at the end, draw it through the remaining stitches, tighten gently and fasten off firmly on the inside.

Size	Start	*k2, k2tog*	*k1, k2tog*	k2tog round	Draw up
Small	24 sts	18 sts	12 sts	6 sts	6 sts
Large	32 sts	24 sts	16 sts	8 sts	8 sts

Do not pull the yarn tight. A hard knot at the top can be felt through the mitten and sits right against the fingertips.

4 • SECOND MITTEN AND CORD

THE SECOND MITTEN

Work the second mitten exactly the same. Check that the leaf and seed patterns start in the same place on both, and count the rounds in pink rather than measuring, so the two come out the same length.

THE I-CORD

Cast on 3 stitches in pink and work an i-cord until the cord measures the length in your column. Cast off. Sew one end firmly to the inside of each cuff, with several small stitches, taking care that the seam does not press against the skin.

Size	I-cord stitches	Cord length
Small	3 sts	40 cm
Large	3 sts	50 cm

The cord goes through the sleeves, never round the neck. Adjust the length to the garment the mittens are worn with, and never use corded mittens unsupervised.

FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the mittens is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

Chest after washing

Time taken, roughly

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

Yarn and needles

Total length after washing

Yarn used, grams

HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.

FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- Mittens with a connecting cord must only be used under supervision.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

SAFETY

Buttons and ties on baby garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. On a premature baby the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

Happy knitting!

STRAWBERRY DREAM

THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless with a leaf yoke and a flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, with a nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper and skirt, a two-piece set with an elasticated waist.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a connecting cord.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with a folded rib cuff and ties at the ankle.

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